

★ ★ ★ Chicks Smash Atlanta 10-5 To Pace Southern

By MERCER BAILEY
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Memphis' Jack Cassini, who is managing from the bench because he couldn't make the ball club, figures Atlanta is the team to beat for the Southern Assn. pennant—so that's just what his Chicks did.

And they did it in convincing fashion last night, chasing Vic Rehm, the Cracker's star rookie southpaw, in the fifth and rolling on to a smashing 10-5 victory.

That made it six straight and 10 of 11 for the classy Chicks, who are threatening to turn the race into a runaway. The loss ended Atlanta's five-game winning streak.

And since Birmingham lost to Little Rock 8-4, the Chicks are breezing along four games ahead of the pack. New Orleans pounded out a 12-8 triumph over Nashville to climb into fifth place and Mobile edged Chattanooga 4-3.

Cassini says Memphis is better at this stage of the game than were his 1955 championship Chicks; so good, in fact, that Cassini sees himself riding the bench all season. A tipoff to the Chicks' caliber is this: Cassini insists shortstop Kent Peterson, a .306 swinger with San Diego of the Pacific Coast last season, will be more valuable than Luis Aparicio, the prize rookie who stepped up to the parent Chicago White Sox.

Lowe Wren, a rookie, went the route for the Chicks and picked up his second victory. A grand-slam homer by Gip Dickens in the seven-run fifth ended Rehm's mound tenure.

Mobile got its winning run on doubles by Gordon Coleman and Dick Brown in the seventh. Coleman earlier had banged his first home run of the year.

Mobile's Bill Dailey and Lookout Alex Gordey both hurled six-hit ball, Gordey giving Chattanooga its second route-going performance of the season. Gordey fanned 10, Dailey five.

Former major leaguer Clarence (Hooks) Iott came on in the fourth and humbled Birmingham's left-handed power lineup with his soft southpaw offerings. Iott allowed only three hits and one run for the 5 and one-third innings he worked.

The Baros' Brank Wehner continued his fine plate work, though, getting three hits for the night, including homer No. 3. Spider Wilhelm homered for Little Rock with a man aboard, helping pin the defeat on previously unbeaten Wilson Parsons.

Frank Rice drove in five New Orleans runs with a pair of homers and a double as the Pels slugged five Vol pitchers of 16 hits. Harry Fisher, a pitcher playing right-field for injured Emil Panko, got another homer. Panko was hit on the head by a ball during batting practice and although he apparently was not hurt badly, manager Andy Cohen decided to give him a rest.

It was so cold in Sulphur Dell that the Vol management told the 438 fans who turned out that their rainchecks would be honored at a later game.